

W H A L E C L A S S

Circle Time Guide

Everything you need, one page per day

Spring & the Life Cycle of Animals

Week 27

Week of Mar 29–Apr 2

13 minutes a day

ages 2.5–6

English learners





Week 27 · Week Overview

Spring & the Life Cycle of Animals
Print · laminate · ring-bind · hold this all week

5 words they'll own by Friday →

spring

egg

chick

caterpillar

butterfly

🌸 Qingming falls on Monday 5 April — school is closed and next week is a four-day week; Friday announces it. The Spring Equinox has just passed, so the standing egg is on the shelf all week.

Littles (2.5–3)

One word + a gesture is a win: **“Egg!”** (two hands make a ball), **“Cheep!”** (a pecking beak with finger and thumb), **“Fly!”** (arms wide, flap slowly).

Bigs (4–6)

Sentence frames: **“It is spring.”** **“This is an egg.”**

“The caterpillar becomes a butterfly.”

“I am growing too.”

The week at a glance

MON	Wake Up, Spring!	a branch with real buds or blossom, cut that morning
TUE	An Egg in the Nest	a real egg sitting in a little nest of straw, in the Magic Box; a second egg, hard-boiled, for...
WED	Crack! A Chick	a fluffy chick and the cracked eggshell it came out of
THU	The Hungry Caterpillar	a caterpillar (a real one in a jar with air holes, or a knitted one) and a leaf full of nibble...
FRI	Butterfly! + Big Review	the chrysalis (a stocking) with a paper butterfly folded up inside it; the life-cycle ring car...

2 MIN

📦 **Magic Box hook**



4 MIN

📢 **Teach the words**



3 MIN

🎵 **Song · today's verse**



3 MIN

⚡ **Game · move it**



1 MIN

🗯️ **Whisper-shout close**

Weekly rituals — use these every single day

Attention grabber: Teacher: **“One, two, three — eyes on me!”** · Kids: **“One, two — eyes on you!”**

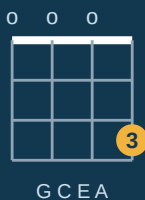
The Magic Box: any box with a lid. Chant it, shake it, sniff it, peek dramatically — the day's key prop lives inside.

The two-tier rule: never make a little produce a sentence, and never let a big get away with one word.

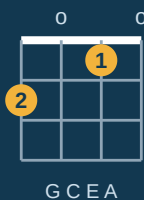
Whisper → shout close: calms them down, then releases them — every single closing.

Teacher-fails-on-purpose: once a day, get it wrong and let them correct you — the correction shout is the loudest language of the day.

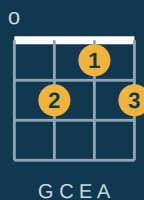
One song a week: same chorus at every circle, one new verse each morning, the whole song on Friday.



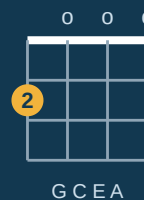
C



F



G7



Am

Uke quick-ref

Strum: Down · Down · Down-Up (“wake — up — wake-up”). Can't manage it yet? Four slow downs per bar works fine — the children are listening to the growing, not the strumming.

The song needs only **C · F · G7 · Am**.

MONDAY

Wake Up, Spring!

Grab: a **branch with real buds or blossom**, cut that morning — it has to be a real one; a jar of water to stand it in where every child can reach it; one **raw egg** for the Spring Equinox egg-standing; the spring card; the picture cards from print pack page 11.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

Today the box will not quite shut — something is sticking out of one end. Hold it up. Whole class chants:

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

Shake it — a dry little rattle of twigs. Now lift the lid a crack and **sniff**, loudly, with your eyes shut. Sniff again. Let your face go amazed.

TEACHER "Something in here was **asleep** all winter... and it has just **WOKEN UP**." (*draw the branch out slowly, buds first, and hold it up against the window*)

The branch goes right round the circle and every child touches one bud with one finger. Then everybody curls up small and stretches up tall: "**Spring!**"

4 MIN TEACH · SPRING

Everybody curls up on the floor as small as they can. We wake up twice — slow, then quick:

The seed is **asleep**, (*curled up tight, head right down*)

The tree is **asleep**, (*still curled, completely still*)

The sun comes **up**... (*rise slowly onto your knees, hands opening*)

and everybody **WAKES!** (*stand and stretch as tall as you can go*)

Then the branch itself, standing in its jar. **Count the buds together**, touching each one as you go. Now say the plain true thing, slowly: nothing on this branch is **finished**. Every bud is on its way to being a leaf, and we are going to watch it happen all week.

LITTLES curl and stretch and say "**Spring!**" **BIGS** take the frame: "**It is spring.**" "**The buds are growing.**"

Teacher fails: stand the branch in the jar **upside down**, blossom under the water, roots-end waving in the air. Step back and admire it. Hold it. Wait.

Chinese moment: lay the **spring** card at the foot of the jar and say **Spring is here!** once, all together. Leave the card there; the row grows by one card a day. Then the **Spring Equinox egg-standing** — stand the raw egg on its end on the shelf and leave it standing there all week.

3 MIN GAME · WAKE UP, SPRING!

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" Everybody chooses one thing to be — a seed, a bear, a bulb, a sleeping bug — and curls up on the floor, completely still. One child is **the sun**, with a yellow scarf.

TEACHER "The sun is coming round... **shhh**... and whoever the sun touches — **WAKES UP!**" (*the sun walks the circle and taps one head at a time*)

The tapped child uncurls, stretches, and says what they are: "**I'm a flower!**" "**I'm a bear!**" **LITTLES** just stretch and say "**Wake up!**" — a full win. Then that child becomes the sun and the game goes on.

Chinese moment: this game *is* the poem. Say Meng Haoran's "**Spring Dawn**" over the top of it, quietly, while the sun walks: *In spring I sleep past dawn; everywhere I hear the birds.* Waking up in spring and hearing birds everywhere — that is exactly what is happening on your carpet.

1 MIN CLOSE

Standing round the branch, curled small and ready to grow. Whisper → normal → shout:

EVERYONE "Egg... chick... **BUTTERFLY!** Wake up, **SPRING!**" (*ball hands · pecking beak · flapping wings · both arms thrown up on the shout*)

Got 3 spare minutes? *Mouse's First Spring* (Lauren Thompson) — one small animal finding one new thing on every page. Let them guess what is under each flap of grass before you turn it.

♪ TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · WAKE UP, IT'S SPRING! chorus → Monday's verse → chorus

CHORUS

C Wake up, wake up — it's **F** spring to **C** day! (*curl small, then stretch tall*)

F Everybody's **C** growing in the **G7** warm, warm **C** day! (*both hands rising apart*)

C An egg, a **F** chick, a caterpillar **Am** too, (*ball hands · pecking beak · one wriggling finger*)

F A butter **C** fly — and **G7** so are **C** you! (*flap and fly, then point at one child*)

MONDAY · SPRING

C The buds pop open, the birds all sing, (*fingers popping open, then a beak*)

G7 Wake up, wake up — **C** it's spring, spring, spring! (*stretch taller on each "spring"*)

The one song of the week — same chorus at every circle, one new verse each morning, the whole thing on Friday. Chords and the full sheet are on the Song tab. Sing it standing round the branch, always.

TUESDAY

An Egg in the Nest

Today's words: **egg** (*spring comes back every day*)

Grab: a **real egg** sitting in a little nest of straw, in the Magic Box; a second egg, **hard-boiled**, for handling; a feely bag with four or five hidden things for the game; the egg card; yesterday's branch and the standing Spring Equinox egg on the shelf.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

Today the box is heavier on one side, and it must be carried **flat**, in two hands. Chant it first:

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

TEACHER "Today we do **NOT** shake the box." (*carry it round the whole circle, held flat, so every child can look in from above*)

Lift the little nest out with both hands and hold it very still. Then, in a whisper: (*one finger touching the shell*)

TEACHER "It's smooth... it's cold... and there is something **alive** inside it."

Two hands make a ball: **"Egg!"**

4 MIN TEACH · EGG

The hard-boiled egg goes round the circle, one child at a time, held in **two hands**, in complete silence. Nobody speaks until it comes back to you. Then, twice, with the actions:

Little white **egg**, (*two hands make a round ball*)

Round and **warm**, (*rock the ball gently, side to side*)

Sleeping, sleeping... (*both hands to your cheek, eyes shut*)

until you are **BORN!** (*open both hands wide, fingers spread*)

Now ask it and take every answer: **what is inside an egg?** A dinosaur, a snake, a cake — take them all seriously. Then tell them: a **chick**. Tomorrow. And say the true part too: the egg on our shelf came from the shop and will never hatch; the ones that *do* hatch sit warm under a hen for **three whole weeks**. Three weeks is a very long time, and that is why waiting belongs in this week.

LITTLES make the ball hands and say **"Egg!"** **BIGS** owe you the frame: **"This is an egg."** **"The chick is inside the egg."**

Teacher fails: announce that *you* will keep the egg warm, and start lowering yourself onto it to sit on it. Keep going. They will stop you.

Chinese moment: the **egg** card joins spring — **egg**. Then everybody gets one turn at the **Spring Equinox egg-standing**: stand the raw egg on its own end on the shelf. It really does work if the hands are patient, and patient hands are the whole lesson today.

3 MIN GAME · WHAT'S IN THE EGG?

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" The feely bag holds four or five things they have already met: a bud, a feather, a stone, the eggshell, a little chick. **No looking**.

TEACHER "Hand in... feel it... **tell us what it is** — and *then* pull it out." (*the whole circle waits; nobody shouts the answer*)

Naming it before seeing it is the work. **LITTLES** get a hint and one word: **"Egg!"** **BIGS** give a sentence before they pull: **"I think it is an egg."** Then out it comes and everybody sees whether they were right.

Put the same thing back in twice, on purpose. A child who feels the egg a second time and names it instantly, without stopping to think, has just shown you the word is theirs.

1 MIN CLOSE

Everybody's hands cupped round an imaginary egg. Whisper → normal → shout:

EVERYONE "Egg... chick... BUTTERFLY! Wake up, SPRING!" (*ball hands · pecking beak · flapping wings · both arms thrown up on the shout*)

Got 3 spare minutes? *An Egg Is Quiet* (Dianna Aston) — every kind of egg there is, on one enormous spread. Let them find the smallest one and the biggest one.

♪ **TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · WAKE UP, IT'S SPRING!** chorus → Tuesday's verse → chorus

CHORUS

C Wake up, wake up — it's **F** spring to **C** day! (*curl small, then stretch tall*)

F Everybody's **C** growing in the **G7** warm, warm **C** day! (*both hands rising apart*)

C An egg, a **F** chick, a caterpillar **Am** too, (*ball hands · pecking beak · one wriggling finger*)

F A butter **C** fly — and **G7** so are **C** you! (*flap and fly, then point at one child*)

TUESDAY · EGG

C In the nest there is an egg, (*cup both hands into a nest*)

G7 Round and warm — **C** and not one leg! (*rock the nest, then shrug*)

Sing this one *quietly*, rocking the nest, and let the last line be the joke it is. Then straight back into the big chorus. Loud, quiet, loud is the shape of every good circle.

WEDNESDAY

Crack! A Chick

Today's words: **chick** (*spring · egg come back*)

Grab: a **fluffy chick** and the **cracked eggshell**
 it came out of — both halves — in the Magic Box; one real feather; the grow card; a clear space to run the circle game in.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

While the class chants, tap the underside of the box quietly with one fingernail — *tap... tap... tap* — and look as if you have no idea where it is coming from.

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

TEACHER "Something in here is trying to get **OUT**." (*peek in, gasp, and lift out the two halves of the cracked shell, one in each hand*)

Hold the two empty halves apart and look inside them, puzzled — where has it gone? Then reach back in and bring out the **chick**. Pecking beak with finger and thumb: "**Cheep! Chick!**"

4 MIN TEACH · CHICK

Everybody is an egg — curled up on the floor, hands over your head. We hatch twice, slow then fast:

Tap, tap, tap — a little **crack**, (*three knuckle taps on the floor*)

Tap, tap, tap — the shell goes **CRACK!** (*one hard clap, all together*)

Out comes a chick, all **fluffy** and small, (*uncurl very slowly, blinking*)

Cheep, cheep, cheep — that's all! (*pecking beak, finger and thumb*)

Then hold the chick and the shell up **together** and put the story in order out loud, pointing: first the **egg**... then the **crack**... then the **chick**... and one day, a big **hen**, who lays an egg. Draw the circle in the air with one finger as you say it. It goes round.

LITTLES peck and say "**Chick!**" **BIGS** owe you a sentence: "**The chick comes out of the egg.**" "**The chick is growing.**"

Teacher fails: try to post the chick back into the shell and press the two halves together round it. "In you go. Back you go." Keep trying. Wait for the uproar.

Chinese moment: the **grow** card joins *spring · egg* — **growing up**, to grow up. Say it about the chick, and then say it about them, pointing at one child at a time: **You are growing too.**

3 MIN GAME · CHICK, CHICK, CHEEP

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" Duck-duck-geese, played entirely in cheeps. Everybody sits in a circle; one child walks round the outside tapping heads.

TEACHER "**Chick... chick... chick... CHEEP!**" (*on "cheep" the tapped child jumps up and they both run the circle back to the empty space*)

LITTLES walk it rather than run it, and a grown-up walks with them. Nobody is out and nobody stands in a middle; the child left standing simply becomes the next one to tap.

Say **chick** five or six times before you say **cheep**. The waiting is what makes them listen, and listening to one word inside a string of another word is the exact skill they need for English.

1 MIN CLOSE

Everybody crouched in a shell, pecking beaks ready. Whisper → normal → shout:

EVERYONE "Egg... chick... BUTTERFLY! Wake up, SPRING!" (*ball hands · pecking beak · flapping wings · both arms thrown up on the shout*)

Got 3 spare minutes? From *Egg to Chicken* — real photographs, in order, of the whole three weeks. Lay the pages against our own shell and chick on the mat as you go.

▶ TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · WAKE UP, IT'S SPRING! chorus → Wednesday's verse → chorus

CHORUS

C Wake up, wake up — it's **F** spring to **C** day! (*curl small, then stretch tall*)

F Everybody's **C** growing in the **G7** warm, warm **C** day! (*both hands rising apart*)

C An egg, a **F** chick, a caterpillar **Am** too, (*ball hands · pecking beak · one wriggling finger*)

F A butter **C** fly — and **G7** so are **C** you! (*flap and fly, then point at one child*)

WEDNESDAY · CHICK

C Crack! Crack! Out comes a chick, (*two hard claps, then uncurl*)

G7 Cheep, cheep, cheep — **C** peck, peck, peck! (*three cheeps up, three pecks down*)

Do the three cheeps **higher** each time and the three pecks **lower** each time. By Friday they will be doing the up-and-down without you and it will be the loudest verse of the week.

THURSDAY

The Hungry Caterpillar

Today's words: **caterpillar** (*spring · egg · chick come back*)

Grab: a **caterpillar** (a real one in a jar with air holes, or a knitted one) and a **leaf full of nibbled holes** in the Magic Box; a long line of paper leaves laid down the corridor **before** the children come in; the chrysalis (a stocking) kept hidden for tomorrow; the insect card.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

Today the box is small and light, and when you tip it something inside slides very slowly from one end to the other. Chant, then tip it — slowly.

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

TEACHER "We are **not** going to shake this one either — it's **alive**." (*lift out the nibbled leaf first and hold it up against the window so the holes shine through*)

Count the holes together, out loud, pointing at each one. Then bring out the caterpillar itself and hold it in two hands, low, so everybody has to be quiet to see it. One wiggling finger: "**Caterpillar!**"

4 MIN TEACH · CATERPILLAR

One finger wriggles up the other arm while you say it, twice, and the second time the whole circle wriggles with you:

A little green **caterpillar**, (*one finger wriggling slowly up your arm*)

Munch, munch, **MUNCH!** (*big chewing jaws made with both hands*)

Leaves for breakfast, (*pick a leaf out of the air and eat it*)

and leaves for **lunch!** (*and another, bigger, messier*)

Then the story, told with your hands: he eats, and eats, and gets **bigger...** and bigger... and then one day he **stops** eating, and hangs himself up, and goes to sleep inside a little bag called a **chrysalis**. Hold up the stocking — but **do not open it**. "Tomorrow." Put it on the shelf where everyone can see it and leave it there, unopened, all day.

LITTLES wriggle a finger and say "**Caterpillar!**" **BIGS** owe you the big frame of the week: "**The caterpillar becomes a butterfly.**" "**He is very hungry.**"

Teacher fails: insist, confidently and repeatedly, that the caterpillar is going to grow up into a **chick**. "Cheep cheep!" Nod wisely. Do it again. Let them shout you down — and make them tell you what it *really* turns into.

Chinese moment: the **insect** card joins spring · egg · grow — **caterpillar**. Say it with the wriggling finger, slowly, and let them say it back three times, getting faster each time.

3 MIN GAME · CATERPILLAR CRAWL

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" The whole class becomes **one** caterpillar: everybody on hands and knees in a single line, each child's hands on the ankles of the child in front, and a line of paper leaves laid down the corridor.

TEACHER "Crawl... and when we reach a leaf — **MUNCH!**" (*the whole line stops, everybody chews, and the leaf is scrunched up and left behind*)

Crawl, munch, crawl, munch, all the way down the corridor. **LITTLES** at the front where they can see; a grown-up at the back so nobody is left behind. Count the leaves you have eaten when you get there.

Go **slowly**. A fast line falls over and turns into a heap. Slow crawling with twenty children joined together is one of the best things they will do all term, and they will ask for it again tomorrow.

1 MIN CLOSE

Everybody down low, one finger wriggling. Whisper → normal → shout:

EVERYONE "Egg... chick... BUTTERFLY! Wake up, SPRING!" (*ball hands · pecking beak · flapping wings · both arms thrown up on the shout*)

Before home time: chalk or tape the **four life-cycle stations** on the floor for tomorrow, in a **circle**, not a line — egg, caterpillar, chrysalis, butterfly — and lay one ring card at each. Tomorrow the class walks it, and walks it again.

Got 3 spare minutes? *The Very Hungry Caterpillar* (Eric Carle) — and let them poke a finger through every hole on the way past.

♪ TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · WAKE UP, IT'S SPRING! chorus → Thursday's verse → chorus

CHORUS

C Wake up, wake up — it's **F** spring to **C** day! (*curl small, then stretch tall*)

F Everybody's **C** growing in the **G7** warm, warm **C** day! (*both hands rising apart*)

C An egg, a **F** chick, a caterpillar **Am** too, (*ball hands · pecking beak · one wriggling finger*)

F A butter **C** fly — and **G7** so are **C** you! (*flap and fly, then point at one child*)

THURSDAY · CATERPILLAR

Am A hungry caterpillar — munch, munch, munch, (*chewing jaws, three big bites*)

G7 Leaves for breakfast, **C** leaves for lunch! (*eat one leaf, then another*)

This is the one verse with the **Am** in it, and **Am** is the sad-sounding chord — which is perfect, because the caterpillar is hungry. If **Am** defeats you, play the whole verse on **C** and nobody in the room will know.

FRIDAY

Butterfly! + Big Review

Today's words: **butterfly** — and **spring** · **egg** · **chick** · **caterpillar**, the whole week

Grab: the **chrysalis** (a stocking) with a paper **butterfly** folded up inside it; the **life-cycle ring cards**; every prop from the week packed into the box; the four floor stations from yesterday; the awards (print pack page 17); the butterfly card. **Monday is Qingming** and school is closed — back on **Tuesday**.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

The box comes out bulging and will not quite shut.

TEACHER "Today the box is **FULL** — it's got our whole WEEK inside it!"

Pull each thing out and hold it up in complete silence. They will supply the word before you can.

The budding branch → "**Spring!**" The egg → "**Egg!**" The chick → "**Chick!**" The nibbled leaf → "**Caterpillar!**"

Last of all, one soft grey thing at the bottom: the **chrysalis**. Hold it up. Nobody knows. Then reach in and draw the butterfly out of it, **slowly**, wings first, and open them. "**BUTTERFLY!**"

4 MIN TEACH · BUTTERFLY, THEN THE WHOLE WEEK

Everybody stands. We do the whole life cycle with our bodies, twice — slow, then fast:

An **egg** on a leaf, (*two hands make a tiny ball*)

A **caterpillar** — munch! (*one wriggling finger, then chewing jaws*)

Fast **asleep** in a little bag, (*curl up small, hands over your head, completely still*)

Then **open wide** — and FLY! (*burst open, arms wide, and fly slowly round the circle*)

Then the four ring cards, laid out on the floor in a **circle**, not a line. Walk it with one child while everybody names the stations out loud — egg, caterpillar, chrysalis, butterfly — and then keep walking, straight past the butterfly and back to the egg. It **does not stop**. Then the question that ends the week, asked quietly, to each child: *and what are you turning into?*

LITTLES do the four gestures and shout the words. **BIGS** owe you a whole sentence each: "**The caterpillar becomes a butterfly.**" "**It is spring.**" "**I am growing too.**"

Teacher fails: lay the four cards out in a straight **line**, stop firmly at the butterfly, dust off your hands and say "The end." Wait for somebody to bend it round into a circle for you.

Chinese moment: the **butterfly** card completes the row — spring · egg · grow · insect · butterfly, the whole week on the mat, and **butterfly** is the one they will keep. Say "Spring Dawn" all the way through, once, while they lie on their backs: *In spring I sleep past dawn; everywhere I hear the birds. Last night came wind and rain — how many blossoms fell?* Then tell them about **Qingming** on Monday: At Qingming we sweep the graves, and we walk in the spring green too — families go out to the countryside in the spring. School is closed on Monday; we come back on **Tuesday**.

3 MIN GAME · WALK THE LIFE CYCLE

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" Four stations on the floor in a ring, one ring card at each: **egg** (curl up tiny) · **caterpillar** (crawl and munch) · **chrysalis** (freeze, arms wrapped round yourself) · **butterfly** (fly).

TEACHER "Egg... caterpillar... chrysalis... **BUTTERFLY!** — and round we go **again**." (*everybody does the action of the station they are standing on, then moves round one*)

Go round three or four times, faster each time, until the whole class is doing it without being told. **LITTLES** simply follow the child in front and copy; that is exactly how they learn it.

Never stop at the butterfly. The moment they carry on round to the egg on their own, without you saying it, the big idea of the week has landed — and that is the assessment, no worksheet required.

1 MIN CLOSE + AWARDS

Every child gets a "You are a STAR!" award to take home with the long-weekend news. Then, standing in the ring, all four gestures:

EVERYONE "Egg... chick... **BUTTERFLY!** Wake up, **SPRING!**" (*ball hands · pecking beak · flapping wings · both arms thrown up on the shout, and everybody flies away*)

Say the dates at the door. Monday is **Qingming** and school is closed; we are back on **Tuesday** and it is a short week. Send the branch home with whoever wants it — by Monday its buds will be leaves.

Got 3 spare minutes? *Waiting for Wings* (Lois Ehlert) or "Spring Is Here" — and then lie on the floor with the lights off and be a chrysalis for one whole quiet minute before home time.

♪ **TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · WAKE UP, IT'S SPRING!** Friday's verse, then the **WHOLE** song, top to bottom

CHORUS

C Wake up, wake up — it's **F** spring to **C** day! (*curl small, then stretch tall*)

F Everybody's **C** growing in the **G7** warm, warm **C** day! (*both hands rising apart*)

C An egg, a **F** chick, a caterpillar **Am** too, (*ball hands · pecking beak · one wriggling finger*)

F A butter **C** fly — and **G7** so are **C** you! (*flap and fly, then point at one child*)

FRIDAY · BUTTERFLY

C Fast asleep, then open wide — (*curled up tight, then burst open*)

G7 A butterfly! **C** Fly, fly, fly! (*arms wide, flapping slowly*)

The finale: chorus → Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday, Friday → chorus, **walking the four stations** as you sing, all the way round and round again. They learned it one verse a morning without ever noticing, and this run-through is the review of the whole week.

★ Wake Up, It's Spring!

Week 27 theme song
C (0003) · F (2010) · G7 (0212) · Am (2000)

The one song of the week — sung at every circle. Same chorus daily, one new verse each morning, full song on Friday.

CHORUS — SING IT EVERY SINGLE DAY

- C** Wake up, wake up — it's **F** spring to **C** day! (*curl small, then stretch tall*)
F Everybody's **C** growing in the **G7** warm, warm **C** day! (*both hands rising apart*)
C An egg, a **F** chick, a caterpillar **Am** too, (*ball hands · pecking beak · one wriggling finger*)
F A butter **C** fly — and **G7** so are **C** you! (*flap and fly, then point at one child*)

MONDAY · SPRING

- C** The buds pop open, the birds all sing, (*fingers popping open, then a beak*)
G7 Wake up, wake up — **C** it's spring, spring, spring! (*stretch taller on each “spring”*)

TUESDAY · EGG

- C** In the nest there is an egg, (*cup both hands into a nest*)
G7 Round and warm — **C** and not one leg! (*rock the nest, then shrug*)

WEDNESDAY · CHICK

- C** Crack! Crack! Out comes a chick, (*two hard claps, then uncurl*)
G7 Cheep, cheep, cheep — **C** peck, peck, peck! (*three cheeps up, three pecks down*)

THURSDAY · CATERPILLAR

- Am** A hungry caterpillar — munch, munch, munch, (*chewing jaws, three big bites*)
G7 Leaves for breakfast, **C** leaves for lunch! (*eat one leaf, then another*)

FRIDAY · BUTTERFLY

- C** Fast asleep, then open wide — (*curled up tight, then burst open*)
G7 A butterfly! **C** Fly, fly, fly! (*arms wide, flapping slowly*)

Strum: Down · Down · Down-Up (“wake — up — wake-up”).

Can't manage it yet? Four slow downs per bar works fine — the children are listening to the growing, not the strumming. Practice this loop for five minutes tonight: **C** (4 strums) → **F** (4 strums) → **C** → **G7** → **C**. That is the whole chorus except one chord, and the one chord left is **Am**, which is a single finger on the second fret of the top string — put it down, strum once, and you have it. C is one finger, F is two, G7 is three, Am is one; learn them in that order. If your fingers get stuck, put the uke down, give one child the nibbled leaf to hold up and do the finger-play instead: the class will not notice, and the actions carry the meaning either way.